A 25-YEAR INITIATIVE · 二十五年計画

A modest plan for a small village in the *mountains.*

奈良県御杖村 森林・分散型エネルギー・地域所有のデータセンター

MITSUE VILLAGE · 奈良県御杖村

One closed school. One *tired forest.* One short list of ideas.

Mitsue is a mountain village in Nara Prefecture. The elementary school closed. The cedar plantations around it are old and unmanaged. The grid is fragile. None of this is unusual in rural Japan — that's the whole point.

If a small, careful intervention works here, it should be copy-pasteable into a thousand other villages with the same pattern.

COORDINATES · 座標

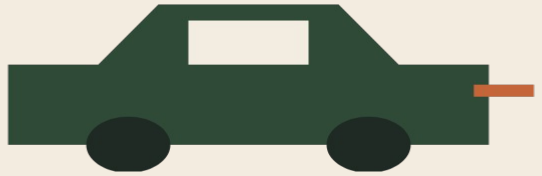
34.4194° N 136.0511° E

POPULATION ≈ 1,400	SCHOOL CLOSED 2020
FOREST COVER ≈ 93%	PROJECT HORIZON 25 yr

Four expensive problems that turn out to be *cheaper together.*

四つの構造的圧力、ひとつの農村型解答

01 · ENERGY



EV cars are coming.

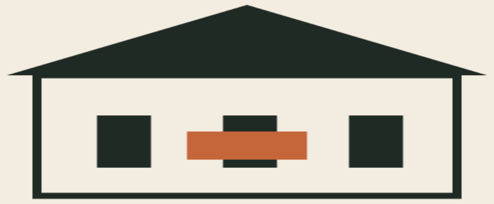
In the near future passenger vehicles will be electric. Rural grids need new distributed generation. Extension is slow and expensive.

02 · FOREST

Cedar is a liability — and a fuel.

Aged sugi plantations: pollen, biodiversity loss, landslide risk. Removing them powers the village; replacing them rebuilds the forest.

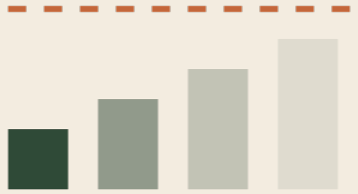
03 · STRANDED



The school just sits there.

Closed schools cost shrinking municipalities money to maintain. Productive reuse turns them into community anchors.

04 · DIGITAL



Rural compute is thin.

Broadband and edge-compute capacity lag urban Japan. A small data center closes both gaps at once, on local power.

Forest. Power. Compute. *One ledger.*

森林再生・分散型再生可能エネルギー・地域所有のデータセンター — 一つの台帳で。

I

Forest restoration

Aged cedar → native broadleaf, on the ecological clock.

II

Local energy + EV

Sugi biomass (the trees we remove) + solar + storage. EV chargers and blackout resilience built in.

III

Edge data center

Closed school, repurposed. Small enough that the village owns it.

EACH REINFORCES THE OTHER. MODEST IN SCALE, PATIENT IN !

We feed the bears, so the bears *stop visiting.*

Phased replacement of aged sugi (cedar) plantations with native broadleaf — oak, chestnut, konara. Done with local landowners and the Forestry Agency. The 25-year arc is the ecological clock, not the funding cycle.

The sugi we remove doesn't go to waste — it becomes the village's primary biomass fuel. The forest pays for its own restoration.

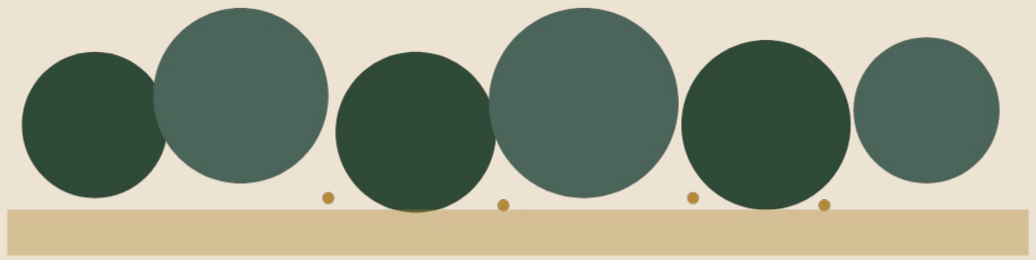
Broadleaf trees produce acorns and nuts that sustain deer, wild boar, and bear through winter. When the forest feeds them, they stay there — and out of the village vegetable patch.

POLLEN	LANDSLIDE RISK	NATIVE CANOPY
↓ down	↓ down	↑ up

BEFORE · 杉人工林

Monoculture. Pollen. Quiet ground.

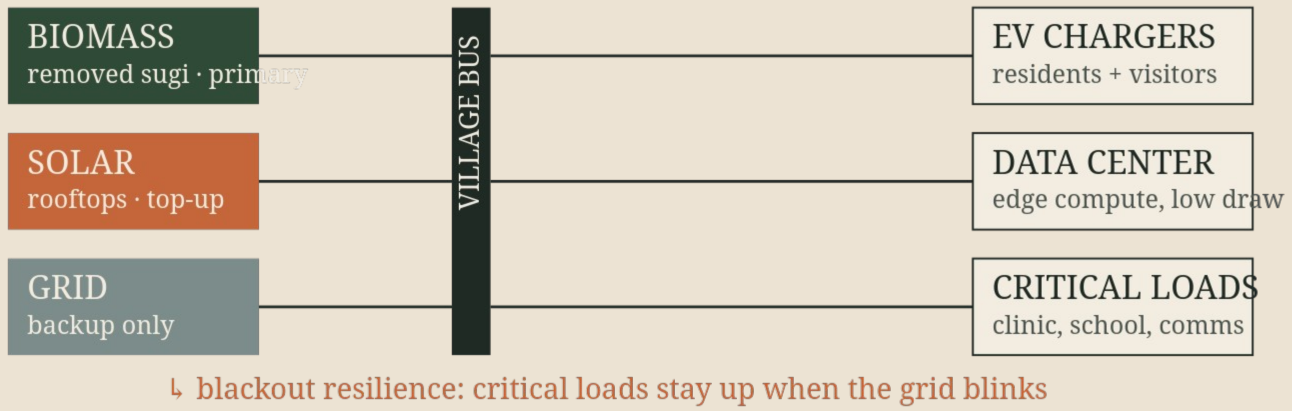
AFTER · 在来広葉樹



Mixed canopy. Acorns. Deer eats here, not your daikon.

The forest powers the village. *Lights stay on* when the grid blinks.

The sugi we remove during forest restoration is the primary fuel for a small village biomass plant — enough to run the data center and the EV chargers. Local solar tops it up, a community battery rides through the dark hours, and the grid is backup only. On-site generation keeps the school, the clinic, and emergency facilities running through blackouts — aging rural distribution lines make those a growing risk.



A data center that goes to *elementary school.*

The closed Mitsue Elementary School building, repurposed as a small, energy-efficient edge-compute facility — powered entirely by locally generated renewable energy.

Sized for accountability, not hyperscale economics. Small enough that the village owns it, audits it, and can explain what it does. Heat re-use warms greenhouses and community buildings. Designed to be replicated by other depopulating municipalities — the blueprint is open.

SCALE	POWER	OWNER
Edge	100% local	The village

The win doesn't depend on the data center being a *commercial hit.*

Most benefits accrue to the village whether the compute side breaks even or not. That's the design.

COMMUNIT]

- ↳ Paid forestry work, year-round
- ↳ EV charging for residents & visitors
- ↳ The school stops bleeding money
- ↳ Blackout-resilient clinic + comms
- ↳ Modest, accountable, village-owned

ENVIRONME:

- ↳ Native broadleaf returns at scale
- ↳ Cedar pollen burden goes down
- ↳ Wildlife pressure on farms drops
- ↳ Landslide risk reduces with age
- ↳ 100% local renewable energy mix

BEYOND MITS

- ↳ Methods + data published openly
- ↳ A replicable rural template
- ↳ CC-BY documents, open licences
- ↳ Designed to be copied, not franchised
- ↳ A bridge to small-scale fusion era

PHASE 0 · PRE-FOUNDATION · 準備期

Quiet on purpose. *No press,* no website launch, no founder hoodies.

Phase 0 is local trust-building, founding-team formation, and clean drafting of the charter. Self-funded, ¥0–0.5M. The work that matters right now is meetings, not announcements.

ADVISORY COMMITMENTS

Joi Ito
Former Director, MIT Media Lab

Ray Ozzie
Software pioneer · ex-Microsoft CSA

✓ COMPLETED

- Initial meeting with Vice Mayor of Mitsue (late 2025)
- Initial meeting with local forestry group (early 2026)
- Founding charter + implementation plan drafted
- Phase / funding-gate flowchart published
- Advisory commitments: Joi Ito, Ray Ozzie

→ IN PROGRESS

- Identifying a Japanese co-founder with rural credibility
- Scheduling a formal meeting with the Village Mayor
- Drafting bylaws for a 一般社団法人
- Engaging a 行政書士 (administrative scrivener) in Nara

○ NEXT 30 DAYS

- Approach candidate Japanese co-founder
- Hold informal meeting with the Village Mayor
- Initial consultations with administrative scriveners
- Finalise the two-page bilingual charter

Five phases. Four *real* funding gates.

Each gate is a checkpoint. Miss one and we hold and re-pitch — we don't accelerate into an under-resourced phase. The funding stack has five layers, deliberately, so no single source can stall the project early.

PHASE 0 · N	PHASE 1	PHASE 2	PHASE 3	PHASE 4
Pre-Foundation	Foundation	Pilot Design	Pilot Build	Operate & Scale
M 1–3 · ¥0–0.5M	M 4–9 · ¥3–8M	M 10–18 · ¥15–30M	M 19–30 · ¥80–200M	M 31+ · revenue-led

G1 · ¥3–8M

G2 · ¥30–50M

G3 · ¥80–200M

G4 · REVENUE ONLINE

FIVE-LAYER FUNDING STACK · YEAR-3 TARGET ≈ ¥134M

Layer	Source	Yr 1	Yr 3
L1	Founder / private	¥3M	¥1M
L2	Government grants	¥5M	¥80M
L3	Foundations	¥3M	¥20M
L4	Corporate partners	¥0	¥30M
L5	Operating revenue	¥0	¥3M
Σ	**Illustrative total**	**¥11M**	**¥134M**

SIX OPERATING PRINCIPLES

I. Local first

II. Open & transparent

III. Patient, long-term

IV. Replicable

V. Modest in scale

VI. Non-partisan

IF YOUR TIME HORIZON MATCHES

We're looking for patient capital, honest critique, and a few *good neighbors.*

WHAT HELPS RIGHT

- ↳ Introductions: Japanese co-founders with rural credibility
- ↳ Advisors: forestry, edge compute, Japanese nonprofit law
- ↳ Patient funders for Phase 1 (¥3–8M)
- ↳ Honest critique — tell us where the thesis is wrong

SCAN TO VIS

mitsue.it

codeberg.org / YR-Design / mitsue-ai-data-center

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PROJECT LE

Rob Oudendijk

YR-Design · Safecast · Mitsue, Nara

THANK YOU ありがとうございま